

A FAMILY RECIPE COLLECTION

The Bennett
Cookbook



Curated, tested, and loved.

8 recipes · 3 full meal builds · Generated 13 May 2026



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Weeknight Winners

10/10 Tuna Pasta

10/10 Tuna Pasta

35 min

Serves 4

Easy

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

Nathan 10.0/10

INGREDIENTS

500g spaghetti

2 x 185g tins tuna in olive oil, drained lightly

500g cherry tomatoes

3 garlic cloves, finely sliced

1/2 cup kalamata olives, pitted and roughly chopped

1/2 cup finely grated parmesan, plus extra to serve

1/2 cup flat-leaf parsley, chopped

1 lemon (optional)

Olive oil

Salt and black pepper

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 220°C. Toss cherry tomatoes with olive oil, salt and pepper. Roast for 18–20 minutes until blistered and collapsing.
2. Cook spaghetti in well-salted boiling water until al dente. Reserve 1 cup pasta water before draining.
3. In a large pan, gently cook garlic in olive oil over medium heat for about 30 seconds until just golden.
4. Add tuna and olives to the pan, keeping some texture in the tuna — don't mash it.
5. Add the roasted tomatoes and their juices. Stir to combine.
6. Add the drained pasta, parmesan and enough reserved pasta water to create a glossy, cohesive sauce.
7. Finish with parsley, plenty of black pepper, and extra parmesan. Add a little lemon zest or juice only if the dish needs lift.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

Roasted tomatoes are non-negotiable — they concentrate and sweeten in a way pan-blistered ones never do. Olives belong in this dish; they're not too much. Keep it glossy, not dry — add pasta water generously. Tuna in olive oil is the move.

Substitutions: Tinned salmon works as a swap. Add capers if you don't have olives.
Linguine or rigatoni in place of spaghetti.

Pairs well with: Garlic bread, Rocket and parmesan salad, Strawberries or simple dessert

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of spaghetti with roasted cherry tomatoes, tuna and kalamata olives in a white ceramic bowl, natural window light, shallow depth of field, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

- pasta
- seafood
- weeknight
- kid-friendly
- family-favourite
- quick
- pantry



Miso Salmon with Coconut Rice and Charred Broccolini

Miso Salmon with Coconut Rice and Charred Broccolini

45 min

Serves 4

Medium

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

Entertaining ★

INGREDIENTS

4 salmon fillets (approx.
180g each)

2 tbsp white miso paste

1 tbsp soy sauce

1 tbsp honey

1 tsp sesame oil

1 tsp fresh ginger, grated
(optional)

1.5 cups jasmine rice

400ml coconut milk

1 cup water

1 tsp salt

2 bunches broccolini

Olive oil

Salt

Lemon wedges

1/2 cucumber, thinly sliced
(to serve)

2 spring onions, sliced (to
serve)

1 tbsp sesame seeds (to
serve)

METHOD

1. Mix miso paste, soy sauce, honey and sesame oil together. Add grated ginger if using. Coat salmon fillets and leave to marinate for 15–30 minutes.
2. Rinse jasmine rice until water runs clear. Combine rice, coconut milk, water and salt in a saucepan. Bring to a boil, reduce heat to low, cover and cook for 12 minutes. Remove from heat and leave covered for 5 minutes.
3. Preheat oven to 200°C. Place marinated salmon on a lined baking tray. Roast for 12–15 minutes depending on thickness — it should be just cooked through with a slightly lacquered top.
4. While salmon roasts, heat a large heavy pan or griddle until very hot. Toss broccolini with olive oil and salt. Char in the hot pan for 4–5 minutes, turning occasionally, until bright green and blistered in places.
5. Serve salmon over coconut rice, broccolini alongside, with cucumber and spring onion scattered over the top. Finish with sesame seeds and a lemon wedge.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

The miso marinade is the whole point — don't skimp on the marinating time. Charred broccolini is the preferred green. This works as a complete dinner; everything is timed to come together at once if you start the rice first.

Substitutions: Works with ocean trout or barramundi. Swap broccolini for broccolini or bok choy. Use regular short-grain rice if jasmine isn't available.

Pairs well with: Cucumber and spring onion garnish, Sesame seeds, Cold Sapporo or sake

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of miso-glazed salmon fillet on coconut rice with charred broccolini, natural window light, shallow depth of field, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

seafood

impressive

family-favourite

full-meal

weeknight

entertaining

healthy-ish

Hidden Zucchini Pesto Pasta

Hidden Zucchini Pesto Pasta

30 min

Serves 4

Easy

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

INGREDIENTS

400g pasta (penne,
rigatoni or fusilli)

2 medium zucchini, finely
grated

190g good-quality store-
bought pesto

300g cherry tomatoes,
halved

Zest and juice of 1 lemon

1/2 cup finely grated
parmesan, plus extra to
serve

Handful fresh basil

Handful flat-leaf parsley

Olive oil

Salt and black pepper

METHOD

1. Cook pasta in well-salted boiling water until al dente. Reserve 1 cup pasta water before draining.
2. While pasta cooks, heat a generous glug of olive oil in a large pan over medium heat. Add grated zucchini with a pinch of salt. Cook, stirring occasionally, for 8–10 minutes until collapsed and sweet — it should lose most of its moisture.
3. Add halved cherry tomatoes to the zucchini and cook for 3–4 minutes until just beginning to soften.
4. Remove from heat. Stir through pesto, lemon zest, a squeeze of lemon juice and parmesan.
5. Add drained pasta and toss to combine, adding pasta water a splash at a time to loosen the sauce to a glossy coat.
6. Finish with basil, parsley, black pepper and extra parmesan.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

The lemon is essential for lifting store-bought pesto — don't skip it. The zucchini is deliberately hidden; grating it finely means it melts into the sauce and fussy eaters won't notice it. This is an intentional strategy, not an accident.

Substitutions: Swap zucchini for finely grated carrot or spinach. Use homemade pesto if you have it.

Pairs well with: Simple green salad, Garlic bread

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of pesto pasta in a wide bowl with visible zucchini, cherry tomatoes and fresh basil, natural window light, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

- pasta
- hidden-veg
- kid-friendly
- weeknight
- vegetarian
- quick



Tomato Herb Pasta

Tomato Herb Pasta

30 min

Serves 4

Easy

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

INGREDIENTS

- 400g pasta
- 500g cherry tomatoes
- 3 garlic cloves, finely sliced
- 1/2 cup good-quality store-bought pesto
- Large handful fresh basil
- Large handful flat-leaf parsley
- 1/2 cup finely grated parmesan, plus extra to serve
- Olive oil
- Salt and black pepper

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 220°C. Toss cherry tomatoes with olive oil, salt and pepper. Roast for 18–20 minutes until blistered and collapsing.
2. Cook pasta in well-salted boiling water until al dente. Reserve 1 cup pasta water.
3. In a large pan, gently cook garlic in olive oil for 30 seconds. Add roasted tomatoes and their juices. Stir in pesto.
4. Add drained pasta and toss, adding pasta water to loosen to a glossy sauce.
5. Remove from heat and stir through basil, parsley and parmesan. Season to taste.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

Simple and reliable. Roasting the tomatoes makes a big difference even for a quick midweek dinner. Fresh herbs added at the end are what make it feel fresh rather than jar-sauce.

Substitutions: Add a tin of cannellini beans for substance. Works with any pasta shape.

Pairs well with: Simple green salad, Garlic bread

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of pasta with roasted cherry tomatoes and fresh herbs in a wide bowl, natural window light, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

pasta weeknight kid-friendly vegetarian quick herbs

Charred Broccolini

Charred Broccolini

10 min

Serves 4

Easy

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

INGREDIENTS

2 bunches broccolini

2 tbsp olive oil

Salt

Lemon wedges to serve

METHOD

1. Heat a large heavy-based pan or griddle over high heat until very hot — it should be slightly smoking.
2. Toss broccolini with olive oil and a good pinch of salt.
3. Add broccolini to the hot pan in a single layer. Cook for 3–4 minutes without moving, until charred and blistered on the underside.
4. Turn and cook for another 2–3 minutes. The broccolini should be bright green, tender and charred in places.
5. Serve immediately with lemon wedges.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

The pan must be very hot before the broccolini goes in. Don't crowd the pan. The char is the whole point — don't be timid about it.

Substitutions: Works with regular broccoli florets, asparagus, or green beans. Add a pinch of chilli flakes or a drizzle of tahini to serve.

Pairs well with: Miso salmon, Any protein, Lemon and sea salt

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of charred broccolini on a white ceramic plate, lemon wedge alongside, natural window light, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

side

vegetarian

quick

healthy-ish

weeknight

Lemon Garlic Yoghurt

Lemon Garlic Yoghurt

5 min

Serves 4

Easy

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup Greek yoghurt
- 1 garlic clove, finely grated
- Juice of 1/2 lemon
- 1 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- Flaky salt
- Freshly cracked black pepper

METHOD

1. Combine Greek yoghurt, grated garlic and lemon juice. Mix well.
2. Season with salt and taste — it should be bright and tangy.
3. Transfer to a serving bowl, drizzle with olive oil and finish with cracked black pepper.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

The yoghurt matters — use full-fat Greek yoghurt, not low-fat. This is the sauce that makes the shakshouka feast. Make it fresh just before serving.

Substitutions: Use labneh for a thicker, richer result. Add a pinch of za'atar or sumac on top. A little tahini stirred through is excellent.

Pairs well with: Shakshouka, Roasted vegetables, Falafel, Any Middle Eastern spread

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of lemon garlic yoghurt in a small white bowl with a drizzle of olive oil, natural window light, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

sauce

side

vegetarian

brunch

quick



Family Favourites

10/10 Tuna Pasta

10/10 Tuna Pasta

35 min

Serves 4

Easy

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

Nathan 10.0/10

INGREDIENTS

500g spaghetti

2 x 185g tins tuna in olive oil, drained lightly

500g cherry tomatoes

3 garlic cloves, finely sliced

1/2 cup kalamata olives, pitted and roughly chopped

1/2 cup finely grated parmesan, plus extra to serve

1/2 cup flat-leaf parsley, chopped

1 lemon (optional)

Olive oil

Salt and black pepper

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 220°C. Toss cherry tomatoes with olive oil, salt and pepper. Roast for 18–20 minutes until blistered and collapsing.
2. Cook spaghetti in well-salted boiling water until al dente. Reserve 1 cup pasta water before draining.
3. In a large pan, gently cook garlic in olive oil over medium heat for about 30 seconds until just golden.
4. Add tuna and olives to the pan, keeping some texture in the tuna — don't mash it.
5. Add the roasted tomatoes and their juices. Stir to combine.
6. Add the drained pasta, parmesan and enough reserved pasta water to create a glossy, cohesive sauce.
7. Finish with parsley, plenty of black pepper, and extra parmesan. Add a little lemon zest or juice only if the dish needs lift.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

Roasted tomatoes are non-negotiable — they concentrate and sweeten in a way pan-blistered ones never do. Olives belong in this dish; they're not too much. Keep it glossy, not dry — add pasta water generously. Tuna in olive oil is the move.

Substitutions: Tinned salmon works as a swap. Add capers if you don't have olives.
Linguine or rigatoni in place of spaghetti.

Pairs well with: Garlic bread, Rocket and parmesan salad, Strawberries or simple dessert

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of spaghetti with roasted cherry tomatoes, tuna and kalamata olives in a white ceramic bowl, natural window light, shallow depth of field, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

- pasta
- seafood
- weeknight
- kid-friendly
- family-favourite
- quick
- pantry



Miso Salmon with Coconut Rice and Charred Broccolini

Miso Salmon with Coconut Rice and Charred Broccolini

45 min

Serves 4

Medium

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

Entertaining ★

INGREDIENTS

4 salmon fillets (approx.
180g each)

2 tbsp white miso paste

1 tbsp soy sauce

1 tbsp honey

1 tsp sesame oil

1 tsp fresh ginger, grated
(optional)

1.5 cups jasmine rice

400ml coconut milk

1 cup water

1 tsp salt

2 bunches broccolini

Olive oil

Salt

Lemon wedges

1/2 cucumber, thinly sliced
(to serve)

2 spring onions, sliced (to
serve)

1 tbsp sesame seeds (to
serve)

METHOD

1. Mix miso paste, soy sauce, honey and sesame oil together. Add grated ginger if using. Coat salmon fillets and leave to marinate for 15–30 minutes.
2. Rinse jasmine rice until water runs clear. Combine rice, coconut milk, water and salt in a saucepan. Bring to a boil, reduce heat to low, cover and cook for 12 minutes. Remove from heat and leave covered for 5 minutes.
3. Preheat oven to 200°C. Place marinated salmon on a lined baking tray. Roast for 12–15 minutes depending on thickness — it should be just cooked through with a slightly lacquered top.
4. While salmon roasts, heat a large heavy pan or griddle until very hot. Toss broccolini with olive oil and salt. Char in the hot pan for 4–5 minutes, turning occasionally, until bright green and blistered in places.
5. Serve salmon over coconut rice, broccolini alongside, with cucumber and spring onion scattered over the top. Finish with sesame seeds and a lemon wedge.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

The miso marinade is the whole point — don't skimp on the marinating time. Charred broccolini is the preferred green. This works as a complete dinner; everything is timed to come together at once if you start the rice first.

Substitutions: Works with ocean trout or barramundi. Swap broccolini for broccolini or bok choy. Use regular short-grain rice if jasmine isn't available.

Pairs well with: Cucumber and spring onion garnish, Sesame seeds, Cold Sapporo or sake

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of miso-glazed salmon fillet on coconut rice with charred broccolini, natural window light, shallow depth of field, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

seafood

impressive

family-favourite

full-meal

weeknight

entertaining

healthy-ish

Hidden Zucchini Pesto Pasta

Hidden Zucchini Pesto Pasta

30 min

Serves 4

Easy

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

INGREDIENTS

400g pasta (penne,
rigatoni or fusilli)

2 medium zucchini, finely
grated

190g good-quality store-
bought pesto

300g cherry tomatoes,
halved

Zest and juice of 1 lemon

1/2 cup finely grated
parmesan, plus extra to
serve

Handful fresh basil

Handful flat-leaf parsley

Olive oil

Salt and black pepper

METHOD

1. Cook pasta in well-salted boiling water until al dente. Reserve 1 cup pasta water before draining.
2. While pasta cooks, heat a generous glug of olive oil in a large pan over medium heat. Add grated zucchini with a pinch of salt. Cook, stirring occasionally, for 8–10 minutes until collapsed and sweet — it should lose most of its moisture.
3. Add halved cherry tomatoes to the zucchini and cook for 3–4 minutes until just beginning to soften.
4. Remove from heat. Stir through pesto, lemon zest, a squeeze of lemon juice and parmesan.
5. Add drained pasta and toss to combine, adding pasta water a splash at a time to loosen the sauce to a glossy coat.
6. Finish with basil, parsley, black pepper and extra parmesan.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

The lemon is essential for lifting store-bought pesto — don't skip it. The zucchini is deliberately hidden; grating it finely means it melts into the sauce and fussy eaters won't notice it. This is an intentional strategy, not an accident.

Substitutions: Swap zucchini for finely grated carrot or spinach. Use homemade pesto if you have it.

Pairs well with: Simple green salad, Garlic bread

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of pesto pasta in a wide bowl with visible zucchini, cherry tomatoes and fresh basil, natural window light, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

- pasta
- hidden-veg
- kid-friendly
- weeknight
- vegetarian
- quick



Vegetarian Lasagna

Vegetarian Lasagna

90 min

Serves 6-8

Advanced

Kid Friendly

Entertaining ★

INGREDIENTS

Dried lasagna sheets
(enough for 3-4 layers in
your dish)

2 onions, diced

3 garlic cloves, minced

2 zucchini, diced

250g mushrooms, finely
chopped

2 carrots, grated

2 x 400g tins crushed
tomatoes

2 tbsp tomato paste

1 tsp dried oregano

1 tsp dried Italian herbs

Olive oil

Salt and black pepper

500g ricotta

2 cups grated mozzarella

1 cup finely grated
parmesan

1 egg

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 190°C.
2. Heat a generous glug of olive oil in a large pan over medium heat. Add onion with a pinch of salt and cook for 8 minutes until soft. Add garlic, cook 1 minute.
3. Add zucchini, mushrooms and carrot. Cook for 10–12 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the vegetables have softened and reduced significantly.
4. Stir in tomato paste and cook for 2 minutes. Add crushed tomatoes and dried herbs. Season well. Simmer for 20–25 minutes until the sauce is thick and rich. Taste and adjust seasoning.
5. In a bowl, mix ricotta with the egg, half the parmesan, and 1/2 cup of mozzarella. Season with salt and pepper.
6. Spread a thin layer of vegetable sauce across the base of a large baking dish. Add a layer of lasagna sheets. Top with vegetable sauce, then dollops of the ricotta mixture. Repeat layers — sauce, sheets, ricotta — finishing with a final layer of sauce.
7. Top generously with remaining mozzarella and parmesan.
8. Cover tightly with foil and bake for 40 minutes. Remove foil and bake for a further 20 minutes until golden and bubbling.

9. Rest for at least 15 minutes before cutting and serving.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

This should be genuinely delicious, not consolation vegetarian food. Resting is mandatory — it holds together so much better. Make it the day before and reheat; the flavours deepen overnight. The ricotta layer is what separates this from a basic bake.

Substitutions: Add a layer of spinach for extra veg. Use fresh pasta sheets for a more luxurious result. Add a small tin of lentils to the sauce for extra substance.

Pairs well with: Rocket and parmesan salad, Garlic bread, Good red wine

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of a slice of vegetarian lasagna served on a white plate, layers visible, golden top, natural window light, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

vegetarian

comfort-food

entertaining

make-ahead

family-favourite

pasta

Tomato Herb Pasta

Tomato Herb Pasta

30 min

Serves 4

Easy

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

INGREDIENTS

- 400g pasta
- 500g cherry tomatoes
- 3 garlic cloves, finely sliced
- 1/2 cup good-quality store-bought pesto
- Large handful fresh basil
- Large handful flat-leaf parsley
- 1/2 cup finely grated parmesan, plus extra to serve
- Olive oil
- Salt and black pepper

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 220°C. Toss cherry tomatoes with olive oil, salt and pepper. Roast for 18–20 minutes until blistered and collapsing.
2. Cook pasta in well-salted boiling water until al dente. Reserve 1 cup pasta water.
3. In a large pan, gently cook garlic in olive oil for 30 seconds. Add roasted tomatoes and their juices. Stir in pesto.
4. Add drained pasta and toss, adding pasta water to loosen to a glossy sauce.
5. Remove from heat and stir through basil, parsley and parmesan. Season to taste.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

Simple and reliable. Roasting the tomatoes makes a big difference even for a quick midweek dinner. Fresh herbs added at the end are what make it feel fresh rather than jar-sauce.

Substitutions: Add a tin of cannellini beans for substance. Works with any pasta shape.

Pairs well with: Simple green salad, Garlic bread

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of pasta with roasted cherry tomatoes and fresh herbs in a wide bowl, natural window light, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

pasta weeknight kid-friendly vegetarian quick herbs



Pasta

10/10 Tuna Pasta

10/10 Tuna Pasta

35 min

Serves 4

Easy

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

Nathan 10.0/10

INGREDIENTS

500g spaghetti

2 x 185g tins tuna in olive oil, drained lightly

500g cherry tomatoes

3 garlic cloves, finely sliced

1/2 cup kalamata olives, pitted and roughly chopped

1/2 cup finely grated parmesan, plus extra to serve

1/2 cup flat-leaf parsley, chopped

1 lemon (optional)

Olive oil

Salt and black pepper

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 220°C. Toss cherry tomatoes with olive oil, salt and pepper. Roast for 18–20 minutes until blistered and collapsing.
2. Cook spaghetti in well-salted boiling water until al dente. Reserve 1 cup pasta water before draining.
3. In a large pan, gently cook garlic in olive oil over medium heat for about 30 seconds until just golden.
4. Add tuna and olives to the pan, keeping some texture in the tuna — don't mash it.
5. Add the roasted tomatoes and their juices. Stir to combine.
6. Add the drained pasta, parmesan and enough reserved pasta water to create a glossy, cohesive sauce.
7. Finish with parsley, plenty of black pepper, and extra parmesan. Add a little lemon zest or juice only if the dish needs lift.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

Roasted tomatoes are non-negotiable — they concentrate and sweeten in a way pan-blistered ones never do. Olives belong in this dish; they're not too much. Keep it glossy, not dry — add pasta water generously. Tuna in olive oil is the move.

Substitutions: Tinned salmon works as a swap. Add capers if you don't have olives.
Linguine or rigatoni in place of spaghetti.

Pairs well with: Garlic bread, Rocket and parmesan salad, Strawberries or simple dessert

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- pasta
- seafood
- weeknight
- kid-friendly
- family-favourite
- quick
- pantry



Hidden Zucchini Pesto Pasta

Hidden Zucchini Pesto Pasta

30 min

Serves 4

Easy

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

INGREDIENTS

400g pasta (penne,
rigatoni or fusilli)

2 medium zucchini, finely
grated

190g good-quality store-
bought pesto

300g cherry tomatoes,
halved

Zest and juice of 1 lemon

1/2 cup finely grated
parmesan, plus extra to
serve

Handful fresh basil

Handful flat-leaf parsley

Olive oil

Salt and black pepper

METHOD

1. Cook pasta in well-salted boiling water until al dente. Reserve 1 cup pasta water before draining.
2. While pasta cooks, heat a generous glug of olive oil in a large pan over medium heat. Add grated zucchini with a pinch of salt. Cook, stirring occasionally, for 8–10 minutes until collapsed and sweet — it should lose most of its moisture.
3. Add halved cherry tomatoes to the zucchini and cook for 3–4 minutes until just beginning to soften.
4. Remove from heat. Stir through pesto, lemon zest, a squeeze of lemon juice and parmesan.
5. Add drained pasta and toss to combine, adding pasta water a splash at a time to loosen the sauce to a glossy coat.
6. Finish with basil, parsley, black pepper and extra parmesan.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

The lemon is essential for lifting store-bought pesto — don't skip it. The zucchini is deliberately hidden; grating it finely means it melts into the sauce and fussy eaters won't notice it. This is an intentional strategy, not an accident.

Substitutions: Swap zucchini for finely grated carrot or spinach. Use homemade pesto if you have it.

Pairs well with: Simple green salad, Garlic bread

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- pasta
- hidden-veg
- kid-friendly
- weeknight
- vegetarian
- quick



Tomato Herb Pasta

Tomato Herb Pasta

30 min

Serves 4

Easy

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

INGREDIENTS

- 400g pasta
- 500g cherry tomatoes
- 3 garlic cloves, finely sliced
- 1/2 cup good-quality store-bought pesto
- Large handful fresh basil
- Large handful flat-leaf parsley
- 1/2 cup finely grated parmesan, plus extra to serve
- Olive oil
- Salt and black pepper

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 220°C. Toss cherry tomatoes with olive oil, salt and pepper. Roast for 18–20 minutes until blistered and collapsing.
2. Cook pasta in well-salted boiling water until al dente. Reserve 1 cup pasta water.
3. In a large pan, gently cook garlic in olive oil for 30 seconds. Add roasted tomatoes and their juices. Stir in pesto.
4. Add drained pasta and toss, adding pasta water to loosen to a glossy sauce.
5. Remove from heat and stir through basil, parsley and parmesan. Season to taste.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

Simple and reliable. Roasting the tomatoes makes a big difference even for a quick midweek dinner. Fresh herbs added at the end are what make it feel fresh rather than jar-sauce.

Substitutions: Add a tin of cannellini beans for substance. Works with any pasta shape.

Pairs well with: Simple green salad, Garlic bread

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pasta weeknight kid-friendly vegetarian quick herbs



Seafood

Miso Salmon with Coconut Rice and Charred Broccolini

Miso Salmon with Coconut Rice and Charred Broccolini

45 min

Serves 4

Medium

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

Entertaining ★

INGREDIENTS

4 salmon fillets (approx.
180g each)

2 tbsp white miso paste

1 tbsp soy sauce

1 tbsp honey

1 tsp sesame oil

1 tsp fresh ginger, grated
(optional)

1.5 cups jasmine rice

400ml coconut milk

1 cup water

1 tsp salt

2 bunches broccolini

Olive oil

Salt

Lemon wedges

1/2 cucumber, thinly sliced
(to serve)

2 spring onions, sliced (to
serve)

1 tbsp sesame seeds (to
serve)

METHOD

1. Mix miso paste, soy sauce, honey and sesame oil together. Add grated ginger if using. Coat salmon fillets and leave to marinate for 15–30 minutes.
2. Rinse jasmine rice until water runs clear. Combine rice, coconut milk, water and salt in a saucepan. Bring to a boil, reduce heat to low, cover and cook for 12 minutes. Remove from heat and leave covered for 5 minutes.
3. Preheat oven to 200°C. Place marinated salmon on a lined baking tray. Roast for 12–15 minutes depending on thickness — it should be just cooked through with a slightly lacquered top.
4. While salmon roasts, heat a large heavy pan or griddle until very hot. Toss broccolini with olive oil and salt. Char in the hot pan for 4–5 minutes, turning occasionally, until bright green and blistered in places.
5. Serve salmon over coconut rice, broccolini alongside, with cucumber and spring onion scattered over the top. Finish with sesame seeds and a lemon wedge.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

The miso marinade is the whole point — don't skimp on the marinating time. Charred broccolini is the preferred green. This works as a complete dinner; everything is timed to come together at once if you start the rice first.

Substitutions: Works with ocean trout or barramundi. Swap broccolini for broccolini or bok choy. Use regular short-grain rice if jasmine isn't available.

Pairs well with: Cucumber and spring onion garnish, Sesame seeds, Cold Sapporo or sake

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of miso-glazed salmon fillet on coconut rice with charred broccolini, natural window light, shallow depth of field, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

seafood

impressive

family-favourite

full-meal

weeknight

entertaining

healthy-ish



Vegetarian

Vegetarian Lasagna

Vegetarian Lasagna

90 min

Serves 6-8

Advanced

Kid Friendly

Entertaining ★

INGREDIENTS

Dried lasagna sheets
(enough for 3-4 layers in
your dish)

2 onions, diced

3 garlic cloves, minced

2 zucchini, diced

250g mushrooms, finely
chopped

2 carrots, grated

2 x 400g tins crushed
tomatoes

2 tbsp tomato paste

1 tsp dried oregano

1 tsp dried Italian herbs

Olive oil

Salt and black pepper

500g ricotta

2 cups grated mozzarella

1 cup finely grated
parmesan

1 egg

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 190°C.
2. Heat a generous glug of olive oil in a large pan over medium heat. Add onion with a pinch of salt and cook for 8 minutes until soft. Add garlic, cook 1 minute.
3. Add zucchini, mushrooms and carrot. Cook for 10–12 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the vegetables have softened and reduced significantly.
4. Stir in tomato paste and cook for 2 minutes. Add crushed tomatoes and dried herbs. Season well. Simmer for 20–25 minutes until the sauce is thick and rich. Taste and adjust seasoning.
5. In a bowl, mix ricotta with the egg, half the parmesan, and 1/2 cup of mozzarella. Season with salt and pepper.
6. Spread a thin layer of vegetable sauce across the base of a large baking dish. Add a layer of lasagna sheets. Top with vegetable sauce, then dollops of the ricotta mixture. Repeat layers — sauce, sheets, ricotta — finishing with a final layer of sauce.
7. Top generously with remaining mozzarella and parmesan.
8. Cover tightly with foil and bake for 40 minutes. Remove foil and bake for a further 20 minutes until golden and bubbling.

9. Rest for at least 15 minutes before cutting and serving.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

This should be genuinely delicious, not consolation vegetarian food. Resting is mandatory — it holds together so much better. Make it the day before and reheat; the flavours deepen overnight. The ricotta layer is what separates this from a basic bake.

Substitutions: Add a layer of spinach for extra veg. Use fresh pasta sheets for a more luxurious result. Add a small tin of lentils to the sauce for extra substance.

Pairs well with: Rocket and parmesan salad, Garlic bread, Good red wine

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of a slice of vegetarian lasagna served on a white plate, layers visible, golden top, natural window light, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

vegetarian

comfort-food

entertaining

make-ahead

family-favourite

pasta



Brunch & Breakfast

Shakshouka Feast

Shakshouka Feast

45 min

Serves 4

Medium

Kid Friendly

Entertaining ★

INGREDIENTS

1 onion, diced

1 red capsicum, diced

3 garlic cloves, minced

2 tsp ground cumin

1 tsp smoked paprika

1/2 tsp chilli flakes
(optional)

800g crushed tomatoes (2
x 400g tins)

6 eggs

Olive oil

Salt and black pepper

Handful flat-leaf parsley or
coriander, roughly chopped

1 cup Greek yoghurt

1 garlic clove, finely grated

Juice of 1/2 lemon

Extra olive oil

Salt

2 ripe avocados, sliced or
smashed

METHOD

1. Heat a generous glug of olive oil in a large, wide ovenproof pan over medium heat. Add onion and capsicum with a pinch of salt and cook for 8–10 minutes until soft and sweet.
2. Add garlic, cumin, paprika and chilli flakes. Stir and cook for 1–2 minutes until fragrant.
3. Pour in the crushed tomatoes. Stir well, then simmer over medium-low heat for 12–15 minutes until the sauce has thickened and deepened in flavour. Season with salt and pepper.
4. Make 6 wells in the sauce using the back of a spoon. Crack an egg into each well. Cover with a lid and cook on medium-low heat for 6–8 minutes until the whites are just set but the yolks are still runny.
5. While eggs cook, mix Greek yoghurt with grated garlic, lemon juice, a drizzle of olive oil and a pinch of salt. Set aside.
6. Scatter the shakshouka with parsley or coriander. Serve straight from the pan alongside the lemon garlic yoghurt, sliced or smashed avocado, and plenty of bread.

Good bread for serving
(sourdough or Turkish)

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

Serve this as a whole spread, not just eggs in sauce. The lemon garlic yoghurt is not optional — it makes the whole thing. Good bread is essential. Avocado rounds it out as a proper brunch feast.

Substitutions: Add crumbled feta on top. Use roasted capsicum from a jar for speed. Swap yoghurt for labneh.

Pairs well with: Lemon garlic yoghurt, Sliced avocado, Good sourdough or pita, Simple herb salad

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of shakshouka in a cast iron pan with six eggs, served on a table spread with yoghurt, avocado and bread, natural window light, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

brunch

vegetarian

full-meal

entertaining

weekend

impressive



Entertaining

Miso Salmon with Coconut Rice and Charred Broccolini

Miso Salmon with Coconut Rice and Charred Broccolini

45 min

Serves 4

Medium

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

Entertaining ★

INGREDIENTS

4 salmon fillets (approx.
180g each)

2 tbsp white miso paste

1 tbsp soy sauce

1 tbsp honey

1 tsp sesame oil

1 tsp fresh ginger, grated
(optional)

1.5 cups jasmine rice

400ml coconut milk

1 cup water

1 tsp salt

2 bunches broccolini

Olive oil

Salt

Lemon wedges

1/2 cucumber, thinly sliced
(to serve)

2 spring onions, sliced (to
serve)

1 tbsp sesame seeds (to
serve)

METHOD

1. Mix miso paste, soy sauce, honey and sesame oil together. Add grated ginger if using. Coat salmon fillets and leave to marinate for 15–30 minutes.
2. Rinse jasmine rice until water runs clear. Combine rice, coconut milk, water and salt in a saucepan. Bring to a boil, reduce heat to low, cover and cook for 12 minutes. Remove from heat and leave covered for 5 minutes.
3. Preheat oven to 200°C. Place marinated salmon on a lined baking tray. Roast for 12–15 minutes depending on thickness — it should be just cooked through with a slightly lacquered top.
4. While salmon roasts, heat a large heavy pan or griddle until very hot. Toss broccolini with olive oil and salt. Char in the hot pan for 4–5 minutes, turning occasionally, until bright green and blistered in places.
5. Serve salmon over coconut rice, broccolini alongside, with cucumber and spring onion scattered over the top. Finish with sesame seeds and a lemon wedge.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

The miso marinade is the whole point — don't skimp on the marinating time. Charred broccolini is the preferred green. This works as a complete dinner; everything is timed to come together at once if you start the rice first.

Substitutions: Works with ocean trout or barramundi. Swap broccolini for broccolini or bok choy. Use regular short-grain rice if jasmine isn't available.

Pairs well with: Cucumber and spring onion garnish, Sesame seeds, Cold Sapporo or sake

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of miso-glazed salmon fillet on coconut rice with charred broccolini, natural window light, shallow depth of field, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

seafood

impressive

family-favourite

full-meal

weeknight

entertaining

healthy-ish

Shakshouka Feast

Shakshouka Feast

45 min

Serves 4

Medium

Kid Friendly

Entertaining ★

INGREDIENTS

1 onion, diced

1 red capsicum, diced

3 garlic cloves, minced

2 tsp ground cumin

1 tsp smoked paprika

1/2 tsp chilli flakes
(optional)

800g crushed tomatoes (2
x 400g tins)

6 eggs

Olive oil

Salt and black pepper

Handful flat-leaf parsley or
coriander, roughly chopped

1 cup Greek yoghurt

1 garlic clove, finely grated

Juice of 1/2 lemon

Extra olive oil

Salt

2 ripe avocados, sliced or
smashed

METHOD

1. Heat a generous glug of olive oil in a large, wide ovenproof pan over medium heat. Add onion and capsicum with a pinch of salt and cook for 8–10 minutes until soft and sweet.
2. Add garlic, cumin, paprika and chilli flakes. Stir and cook for 1–2 minutes until fragrant.
3. Pour in the crushed tomatoes. Stir well, then simmer over medium-low heat for 12–15 minutes until the sauce has thickened and deepened in flavour. Season with salt and pepper.
4. Make 6 wells in the sauce using the back of a spoon. Crack an egg into each well. Cover with a lid and cook on medium-low heat for 6–8 minutes until the whites are just set but the yolks are still runny.
5. While eggs cook, mix Greek yoghurt with grated garlic, lemon juice, a drizzle of olive oil and a pinch of salt. Set aside.
6. Scatter the shakshouka with parsley or coriander. Serve straight from the pan alongside the lemon garlic yoghurt, sliced or smashed avocado, and plenty of bread.

Good bread for serving
(sourdough or Turkish)

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

Serve this as a whole spread, not just eggs in sauce. The lemon garlic yoghurt is not optional — it makes the whole thing. Good bread is essential. Avocado rounds it out as a proper brunch feast.

Substitutions: Add crumbled feta on top. Use roasted capsicum from a jar for speed. Swap yoghurt for labneh.

Pairs well with: Lemon garlic yoghurt, Sliced avocado, Good sourdough or pita, Simple herb salad

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of shakshouka in a cast iron pan with six eggs, served on a table spread with yoghurt, avocado and bread, natural window light, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

brunch

vegetarian

full-meal

entertaining

weekend

impressive

Vegetarian Lasagna

Vegetarian Lasagna

90 min

Serves 6-8

Advanced

Kid Friendly

Entertaining ★

INGREDIENTS

Dried lasagna sheets
(enough for 3-4 layers in
your dish)

2 onions, diced

3 garlic cloves, minced

2 zucchini, diced

250g mushrooms, finely
chopped

2 carrots, grated

2 x 400g tins crushed
tomatoes

2 tbsp tomato paste

1 tsp dried oregano

1 tsp dried Italian herbs

Olive oil

Salt and black pepper

500g ricotta

2 cups grated mozzarella

1 cup finely grated
parmesan

1 egg

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 190°C.
2. Heat a generous glug of olive oil in a large pan over medium heat. Add onion with a pinch of salt and cook for 8 minutes until soft. Add garlic, cook 1 minute.
3. Add zucchini, mushrooms and carrot. Cook for 10–12 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the vegetables have softened and reduced significantly.
4. Stir in tomato paste and cook for 2 minutes. Add crushed tomatoes and dried herbs. Season well. Simmer for 20–25 minutes until the sauce is thick and rich. Taste and adjust seasoning.
5. In a bowl, mix ricotta with the egg, half the parmesan, and 1/2 cup of mozzarella. Season with salt and pepper.
6. Spread a thin layer of vegetable sauce across the base of a large baking dish. Add a layer of lasagna sheets. Top with vegetable sauce, then dollops of the ricotta mixture. Repeat layers — sauce, sheets, ricotta — finishing with a final layer of sauce.
7. Top generously with remaining mozzarella and parmesan.
8. Cover tightly with foil and bake for 40 minutes. Remove foil and bake for a further 20 minutes until golden and bubbling.

9. Rest for at least 15 minutes before cutting and serving.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

This should be genuinely delicious, not consolation vegetarian food. Resting is mandatory — it holds together so much better. Make it the day before and reheat; the flavours deepen overnight. The ricotta layer is what separates this from a basic bake.

Substitutions: Add a layer of spinach for extra veg. Use fresh pasta sheets for a more luxurious result. Add a small tin of lentils to the sauce for extra substance.

Pairs well with: Rocket and parmesan salad, Garlic bread, Good red wine

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of a slice of vegetarian lasagna served on a white plate, layers visible, golden top, natural window light, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

vegetarian

comfort-food

entertaining

make-ahead

family-favourite

pasta

Charred Broccolini

Charred Broccolini

10 min

Serves 4

Easy

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

INGREDIENTS

2 bunches broccolini

2 tbsp olive oil

Salt

Lemon wedges to serve

METHOD

1. Heat a large heavy-based pan or griddle over high heat until very hot — it should be slightly smoking.
2. Toss broccolini with olive oil and a good pinch of salt.
3. Add broccolini to the hot pan in a single layer. Cook for 3–4 minutes without moving, until charred and blistered on the underside.
4. Turn and cook for another 2–3 minutes. The broccolini should be bright green, tender and charred in places.
5. Serve immediately with lemon wedges.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

The pan must be very hot before the broccolini goes in. Don't crowd the pan. The char is the whole point — don't be timid about it.

Substitutions: Works with regular broccoli florets, asparagus, or green beans. Add a pinch of chilli flakes or a drizzle of tahini to serve.

Pairs well with: Miso salmon, Any protein, Lemon and sea salt

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of charred broccolini on a white ceramic plate, lemon wedge alongside, natural window light, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

side

vegetarian

quick

healthy-ish

weeknight

Lemon Garlic Yoghurt

Lemon Garlic Yoghurt

5 min

Serves 4

Easy

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup Greek yoghurt
- 1 garlic clove, finely grated
- Juice of 1/2 lemon
- 1 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- Flaky salt
- Freshly cracked black pepper

METHOD

1. Combine Greek yoghurt, grated garlic and lemon juice. Mix well.
2. Season with salt and taste — it should be bright and tangy.
3. Transfer to a serving bowl, drizzle with olive oil and finish with cracked black pepper.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

The yoghurt matters — use full-fat Greek yoghurt, not low-fat. This is the sauce that makes the shakshouka feast. Make it fresh just before serving.

Substitutions: Use labneh for a thicker, richer result. Add a pinch of za'atar or sumac on top. A little tahini stirred through is excellent.

Pairs well with: Shakshouka, Roasted vegetables, Falafel, Any Middle Eastern spread

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of lemon garlic yoghurt in a small white bowl with a drizzle of olive oil, natural window light, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

sauce

side

vegetarian

brunch

quick



Sides & Sauces

Charred Broccolini

Charred Broccolini

10 min

Serves 4

Easy

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

INGREDIENTS

2 bunches broccolini

2 tbsp olive oil

Salt

Lemon wedges to serve

METHOD

1. Heat a large heavy-based pan or griddle over high heat until very hot — it should be slightly smoking.
2. Toss broccolini with olive oil and a good pinch of salt.
3. Add broccolini to the hot pan in a single layer. Cook for 3–4 minutes without moving, until charred and blistered on the underside.
4. Turn and cook for another 2–3 minutes. The broccolini should be bright green, tender and charred in places.
5. Serve immediately with lemon wedges.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

The pan must be very hot before the broccolini goes in. Don't crowd the pan. The char is the whole point — don't be timid about it.

Substitutions: Works with regular broccoli florets, asparagus, or green beans. Add a pinch of chilli flakes or a drizzle of tahini to serve.

Pairs well with: Miso salmon, Any protein, Lemon and sea salt

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of charred broccolini on a white ceramic plate, lemon wedge alongside, natural window light, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

side

vegetarian

quick

healthy-ish

weeknight

Lemon Garlic Yoghurt

Lemon Garlic Yoghurt

5 min

Serves 4

Easy

Kid Friendly

Weeknight ★

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup Greek yoghurt
- 1 garlic clove, finely grated
- Juice of 1/2 lemon
- 1 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- Flaky salt
- Freshly cracked black pepper

METHOD

1. Combine Greek yoghurt, grated garlic and lemon juice. Mix well.
2. Season with salt and taste — it should be bright and tangy.
3. Transfer to a serving bowl, drizzle with olive oil and finish with cracked black pepper.

NATHAN'S TWEAKS

The yoghurt matters — use full-fat Greek yoghurt, not low-fat. This is the sauce that makes the shakshouka feast. Make it fresh just before serving.

Substitutions: Use labneh for a thicker, richer result. Add a pinch of za'atar or sumac on top. A little tahini stirred through is excellent.

Pairs well with: Shakshouka, Roasted vegetables, Falafel, Any Middle Eastern spread

Image prompt: Premium modern cookbook photograph of lemon garlic yoghurt in a small white bowl with a drizzle of olive oil, natural window light, warm neutral tones, modern Australian family cookbook aesthetic, no text, no people.

sauce

side

vegetarian

brunch

quick

Full Meal Builds

Complete menu suggestions — component recipes linked throughout.

Salmon Dinner

A weeknight-capable Japanese-inspired dinner. Miso-glazed salmon over coconut rice with charred broccolini. Impressive enough for guests, easy enough for Tuesday.

Serves: 4 **Time:** 45 minutes

→ [Miso Salmon with Coconut Rice and Charred Broccolini](#)

→ [Charred Broccolini](#)

Start the rice first — it takes the longest. Get the broccolini into the hot pan while the salmon roasts. Everything lands on the table at the same time if you sequence it right. Add cucumber and spring onion at the end for freshness.

weeknight

entertaining

family

Shakshouka Feast

A generous Middle Eastern brunch spread built around a pan of shakshouka. The lemon garlic yoghurt and avocado are part of the meal, not optional extras.

Serves: 4-6 **Time:** 45 minutes

→ Shakshouka Feast

→ Lemon Garlic Yoghurt

Put the lemon garlic yoghurt and avocado on the table while the shakshouka simmers. Have good bread warm and ready. Serve straight from the pan.

brunch

entertaining

weekend

Italian Family Night

A proper Italian family dinner. Either the 10/10 Tuna Pasta or the Vegetarian Lasagna as the centrepiece, with a rocket salad and garlic bread alongside.

Serves: 4-6 **Time:** 60-90 minutes depending on main

→ 10/10 Tuna Pasta

→ Vegetarian Lasagna

Choose one main — pasta for a weeknight-friendly version, lasagna for a proper occasion. The lasagna benefits from being made the day before. Finish with strawberries or something simple. Good red wine.

family

entertaining

weekend

Recipe Index

RECIPE	CATEGORY	CUISINE	SERVES	TIME	DIFFICULTY
10/10 Tuna Pasta	Pasta	Italian-inspired	4	35min	Easy
Charred Broccolini	Sides & Sauces	Modern Australian	4	10min	Easy
Hidden Zucchini Pesto Pasta	Pasta	Italian-inspired	4	30min	Easy
Lemon Garlic Yoghurt	Sides & Sauces	Middle Eastern-inspired	4	5min	Easy
Miso Salmon with Coconut Rice and Charred Broccolini	Seafood	Asian-inspired	4	45min	Medium
Shakshouka Feast	Brunch & Breakfast	Middle Eastern-inspired	4	45min	Medium
Tomato Herb Pasta	Pasta	Italian-inspired	4	30min	Easy
Vegetarian Lasagna	Vegetarian	Italian	6-8	90min	Advanced